Australian Government Fair Work OMBUDSMAN

# Pay Guide - Marine Towage Award [MA000050]

Published 28 November 2025

**When do the rates in the pay guide apply from?** The first full pay period starting on or after 28 November 2025.

**What is in this pay guide?** It's a summary of the award rates. Go to the award for information about coverage, classifications, conditions and the operation of minimum rates, allowances, penalty rates and overtime.

**Where can I go for more information?** Our Pay and Conditions Tool can help you work out pay rates, leave, notice and redundancy minimum entitlements based on the information you provide. Our website also provides useful templates, best practice guides, fact sheets and online courses.

## Disclaimer

The Fair Work Ombudsman is committed to ensuring that information available through this pay guide including data is accurate and incorporates changes to minimum rates of pay, allowances and penalty rates in the award as soon as they come into effect.

However, we cannot guarantee or accept any liability for the accuracy, reliability, currency or completeness of the information available in this pay guide. This is because, for example, there may be a delay between when a change takes effect, and when the information available in the guide is updated.

When considering information available in the pay guide about awards you should also have regard to the terms of the relevant award, which can be found through our Awards page. If our information is inconsistent with the award, then the award applies.

If you need further assistance you can contact us. Alternatively, you may wish to get independent advice from a union, employer association or lawyer on your particular circumstances.

We encourage you to subscribe to email updates to receive alerts when pay rates and entitlements change in this pay guide.

# Rates of pay

## Adult

### Full-time & part-time - Not special voyages

| Classification | Weekly pay rate | Hourly pay rate | Daily pay rate | Public holiday | Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours | Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after 2 hours | Overtime - Sunday | Extended hours - more than 16 continuous hours | Overtime - public holiday |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Rating / General purpose rating | $1,046.50 | $29.90 | $149.50 | $44.85 | $44.85 | $59.80 | $59.80 | $59.80 | $74.75 |
| **Category 1 (0-1850 tonnage/power units)** | | | | | | | | | |
| Mate | $1,189.10 | $33.97 | $169.87 | $50.96 | $50.96 | $67.94 | $67.94 | $67.94 | $84.93 |
| Master/Engineer | $1,427.20 | $40.78 | $203.89 | $61.17 | $61.17 | $81.56 | $81.56 | $81.56 | $101.95 |
| **Category 2 (1850 or more tonnage/power units)** | | | | | | | | | |
| Mate | $1,242.10 | $35.49 | $177.44 | $53.24 | $53.24 | $70.98 | $70.98 | $70.98 | $88.73 |
| Master/Engineer | $1,504.50 | $42.99 | $214.93 | $64.49 | $64.49 | $85.98 | $85.98 | $85.98 | $107.48 |

### Full-time & part-time - Special voyages in harbour towage operations - Free running voyage

| Classification | Daily pay rate - first 24 hours | After 24 hours - for each 8 hours (or part of 8 hours) worked |
|---|---|---|
| General purpose rating | $587.17 | $239.20 |
| **Category 1 (0-1850 tonnage/power units)** | | |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $700.66 | $271.76 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $856.51 | $326.24 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $908.36 | $326.24 |
| **Category 2 (1850 or more tonnage/power units)** | | |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $700.66 | $283.92 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $856.51 | $343.92 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $908.36 | $343.92 |

## Full-time & part-time - Special voyages in harbour towage operations - Contract towage

| Classification | Daily pay rate - first 24 hours | After 24 hours - for each 8 hours (or part of 8 hours) worked |
|---|---|---|
| General purpose rating | $786.34 | $239.20 |
| **Category 1 (0-1850 tonnage/power units)** | | |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $899.96 | $271.76 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $1,055.50 | $326.24 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $1,102.67 | $326.24 |
| **Category 2 (1850 or more tonnage/power units)** | | |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $899.96 | $283.92 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $1,055.50 | $343.92 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $1,102.67 | $343.92 |

## Full-time & part-time - Special voyages in harbour towage operations - Delivery voyage

| Classification | Daily pay rate |
|---|---|
| General purpose rating | $587.17 |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $700.66 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $856.51 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $908.36 |

## Full-time & part-time - Special voyages in harbour towage operations - Emergency towage operations

| Classification | Daily pay rate |
|---|---|
| General purpose rating | $985.46 |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $1,099.47 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $1,255.95 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $1,313.75 |

## Casual - Not special voyages

| Classification | Hourly pay rate | Public holiday | Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours | Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after 2 hours | Overtime - Sunday | Extended hours - more than 16 continuous hours | Overtime - public holiday |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Rating / General purpose rating | $37.38 | $52.33 | $56.06 | $74.75 | $74.75 | $67.28 | $74.75 |
| **Category 1 (0-1850 tonnage/power units)** | | | | | | | |
| Mate | $42.46 | $59.45 | $63.69 | $84.93 | $84.93 | $76.43 | $84.93 |
| Master/Engineer | $50.98 | $71.37 | $76.46 | $101.95 | $101.95 | $91.76 | $101.95 |
| **Category 2 (1850 or more tonnage/power units)** | | | | | | | |
| Mate | $44.36 | $62.11 | $66.54 | $88.73 | $88.73 | $79.85 | $88.73 |
| Master/Engineer | $53.74 | $75.23 | $80.61 | $107.48 | $107.48 | $96.73 | $107.48 |

## Casual - Special voyages in harbour towage operations - Free running voyage

Casual employees on special voyages receive either the hourly pay rate for the number of hours worked or the daily pay rate, whichever is higher.

| Classification | Hourly pay rate | Daily pay rate - first 24 hours | After 24 hours - for each 8 hours (or part of 8 hours) worked |
|---|---|---|---|
| General purpose rating | $37.38 | $587.17 | $239.20 |
| **Category 1 (0-1850 tonnage/power units)** | | | |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $42.46 | $700.66 | $271.76 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $50.98 | $856.51 | $326.24 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $50.98 | $908.36 | $326.24 |
| **Category 2 (1850 or more tonnage/power units)** | | | |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $44.36 | $700.66 | $283.92 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $53.74 | $856.51 | $343.92 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $53.74 | $908.36 | $343.92 |

## Casual - Special voyages in harbour towage operations - Contract towage

Casual employees on special voyages receive either the hourly pay rate for the number of hours worked or the daily pay rate, whichever is higher.

| Classification | Hourly pay rate | Daily pay rate - first 24 hours | After 24 hours - for each 8 hours (or part of 8 hours) worked |
|---|---|---|---|
| General purpose rating | $37.38 | $786.34 | $239.20 |
| **Category 1 (0-1850 tonnage/power units)** | | | |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $42.46 | $899.96 | $271.76 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $50.98 | $1,055.50 | $326.24 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $50.98 | $1,102.67 | $326.24 |
| **Category 2 (1850 or more tonnage/power units)** | | | |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $44.36 | $899.96 | $283.92 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $53.74 | $1,055.50 | $343.92 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $53.74 | $1,102.67 | $343.92 |

## Casual - Special voyages in harbour towage operations - Delivery voyage

Casual employees on special voyages receive either the hourly pay rate for the number of hours worked or the daily pay rate, whichever is higher.

| Classification | Hourly pay rate | Daily pay rate |
|---|---|---|
| General purpose rating | $37.38 | $587.17 |
| **Category 1 (0-1850 tonnage/power units)** | | |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $42.46 | $700.66 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $50.98 | $856.51 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $50.98 | $908.36 |
| **Category 2 (1850 or more tonnage/power units)** | | |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $44.36 | $700.66 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $53.74 | $856.51 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $53.74 | $908.36 |

## Casual - Special voyages in harbour towage operations - Emergency towage operations

Casual employees on special voyages receive either the hourly pay rate for the number of hours worked or the daily pay rate, whichever is higher.

| Classification | Hourly pay rate | Daily pay rate |
|---|---|---|
| General purpose rating | $37.38 | $985.46 |
| **Category 1 (0-1850 tonnage/power units)** | | |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $42.46 | $1,099.47 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $50.98 | $1,255.95 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $50.98 | $1,313.75 |
| **Category 2 (1850 or more tonnage/power units)** | | |
| Mate (Casual or Tug Mate) | $44.36 | $1,099.47 |
| Mate (Permanent Tug Master) & Engineer | $53.74 | $1,255.95 |
| Master & Chief Engineer | $53.74 | $1,313.75 |

## Allowances

| Allowances | Rate |
|---|---|
| Expenses reimbursement | reimbursement for any expenses reasonably incurred |
| Industrial / protective clothing and equipment allowance | reimbursement for the cost of the clothing and equipment |
| Loss of personal effects allowance - outside work | compensation for loss or damage to a maximum of $476.32 per item with a maximum total payment of $2,856.00 |
| Loss of personal effects allowance - not outside work | compensation for loss or damage to a maximum of $476.32 per item with a maximum total payment of $1,790.00 |
| Out-port meal allowances | $20.45 for breakfast, $23.95 for lunch and $38.57 for dinner, per day |
| Out-port accommodation allowance | $107.06 per day |
| Sunglasses allowance | $51.60 per year |
| Transport reimbursement - travelling between home port and another port | reimbursement for the reasonable cost of transport |
| Travelling time allowance - travelling between home port and another port | payment for travel time as time worked |
| Cyclone shipkeeping allowance - Harbour towage operations | $20.51 per hour |
| Emergency maintenance allowance - Harbour towage operations - General purpose rating | $69.28 per hour |
| Emergency maintenance allowance - Harbour towage operations - Category 1 (0-1850 tonnage/power units) - Mate | $86.34 per hour |
| Emergency maintenance allowance - Harbour towage operations - Category 1 (0-1850 tonnage/power units) - Master and Engineer | $109.99 per hour |
| Emergency maintenance allowance - Harbour towage operations - Category 2 (1850 or more tonnage/power units) - Mate | $79.53 per hour |
| Emergency maintenance allowance - Harbour towage operations - Category 2 (1850 or more tonnage/power units) - Master and Engineer | $114.70 per hour |
| Firefighting insurance allowance - Harbour towage operations | allowance equal to the annual insurance policy premium |
| Insurance policy outside work allowance - Harbour towage operations | allowance equal to the annual insurance policy premium |
| Meal allowance - Harbour towage operations | $18.42 per day |
| Nominated voyage allowance - Harbour towage operations | $25.74 per hour |
| Phone reimbursement - Harbour towage operations | reimbursement of $166.03 per year |
| Phone installation reimbursement - Harbour towage operations | reimbursement for the installation of a new service and transfer costs on one occasion |
| Cooking allowance - Rating and General purpose rating acting as Cook - Tug and barge operations | $43.64 per week |
| Additional skills allowance - Rating and General purpose rating qualified as Crane driver, Able seaman or Offshore watch-keeper allowance - Tug and barge operations | $130.92 per week |

| Allowances | Rate |
| --- | --- |
| Medical and passport allowances - Tug and barge operations | allowance equal to the cost of the medical examination, eyesight or hearing test, passport and visas required |
| Multiple tow allowance - Tug and barge operations - Engineer, Mate and General purpose rating | $61.85 per day |
| Multiple tow allowance - Tug and barge operations - Master and Chief engineer | $122.34 per day |